Sunnyside Environmental E.S.

Changes beginning in 2027-28

WHAT'S HAPPENING?

- Sunnyside would change to a K-5 neighborhood school and would welcome 50% of the neighborhood school boundary from Buckman (the area north of Burnside).
- Middle grade (6th-8th) students would move to Hosford Middle School.
- Sunnyside K-5 Environmental School would continue in the focus option lottery.
- Middle and high school path: High school students would move to Cleveland High School instead of Franklin High School.

WHY IS PPS CONSIDERING THIS?

- Richer middle school options: Changing Sunnyside from a K-8 special-focus choice school to a K-5 neighborhood school allows 6th-8th grade students to access a focused middle school with sustainable programming. This means students will have more access to educational activities.
- Better building conditions: Sunnyside provides a central location and better building conditions compared to the closing Buckman school.

WHAT ELSE WAS CONSIDERED?

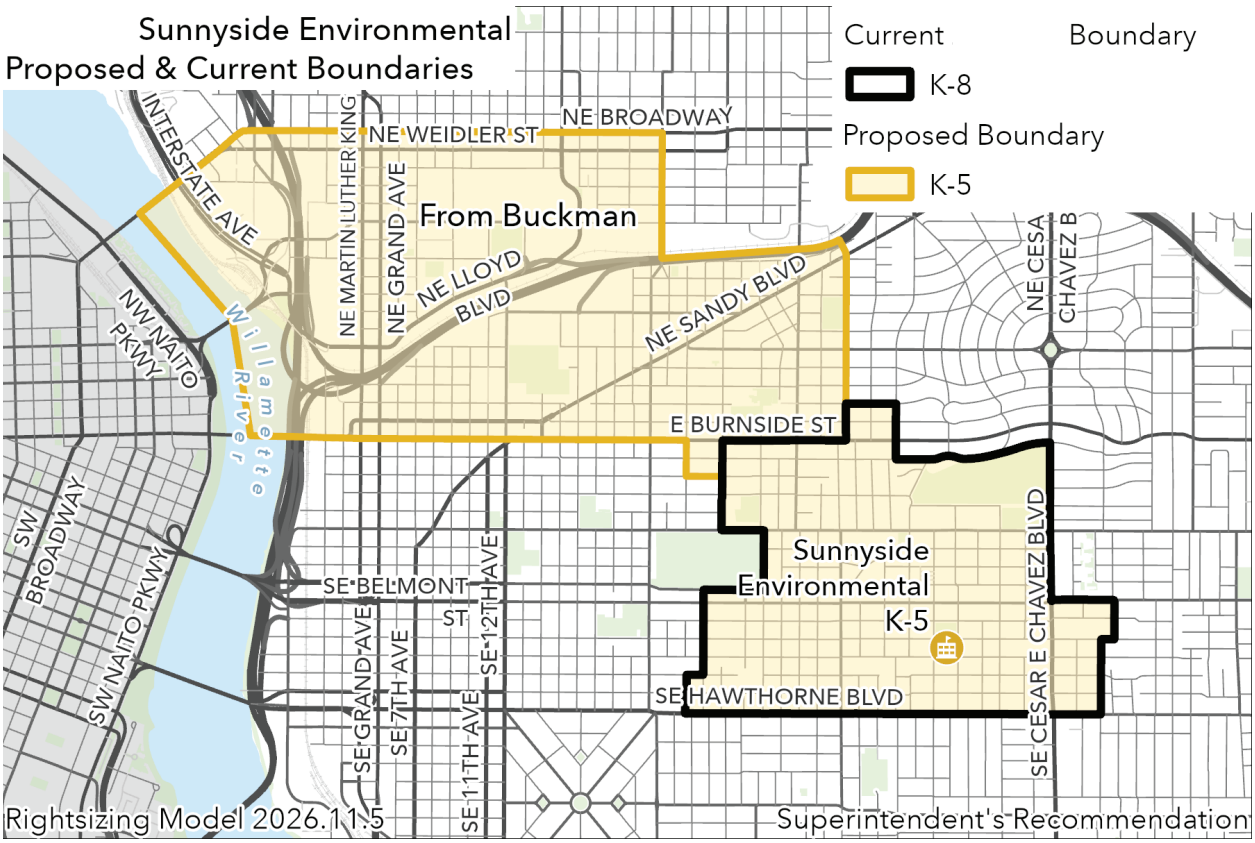
- Sunnyside Environmental School has been a high demand lottery program. Retaining the choice portion for the Sunnyside Environmental School mitigates the impact of closing the Buckman Arts program and provides families with access to at least one of the two choice options.

WHAT WOULD STUDENTS GAIN?

- Updated building environment: Incoming Buckman students move into a facility that has received substantial updates.
- Comprehensive middle school access: Neighborhood 6th-8th graders join Hosford for broader electives, athletics, and middle school staff.

WHERE WOULD THE SCHOOL BOUNDARY BE?

Sunnyside Environmental E.S. boundary



SCHOOL BUILDING CAPACITY & ENROLLMENT

	Functional Capacity	Utilization %	Historical Peak Enrollment	Current Enrollment (2026-2027)
Receiving site	492	98.4%	608 (2011-12)	506

Projected enrollment

School Year	2027-28	2028-29	2029-30	2030-31	2031-32
Status Quo/No Change	484	481	474	478	475
Recommendation	480	479	494	493	482

ENROLLMENT AND TRANSFER

- Neighborhood students: K-4th grade students attending Buckman and incoming K students residing in the Buckman attendance area north of E Burnside St. will enroll at Sunnyside E.S. 5th-7th grade students residing in the Sunnyside attendance area will enroll at Hosford M.S. 8th grade students residing in the Sunnyside attendance area will enroll at Cleveland H.S.

- PPS transfer students: K-4th grade students attending Buckman E.S. but not residing in the attendance area will enroll at Sunnyside or may transfer to their neighborhood school by home address. 5th-7th grade students who attend Sunnyside but do not reside in the attendance area will enroll at Hosford M.S. or may transfer to their neighborhood school by home address.

WHO WOULD THE SCHOOL SERVE?

Option	Poverty	Special education	Multilingual services	Underserved racial groups	Title I
Status Quo/No Change	19%	23.5%	1.4%	12.2%	Not Title 1
Recommendation	24.3%	21.4%	3.8%	14.1%	Not Title 1

ACADEMIC PROGRAM TRANSITIONS

- Academic Programs: Based on current enrollment projections, there will be two to three classrooms at each grade-level, with blends not required. Currently, Buckman has blended elementary classrooms and Sunnyside does not. The Academics team will work with educators to plan curriculum for students who are in blends during the 2026-27 school year and may not be during the 2027-28 school year. Sunnyside will serve only K-5 students and will retain its Environmental Focus Option program. The Academics team will work with staff to merge the instructional program currently in place at Buckman with that at Sunnyside, including consideration of Buckman's current Arts focus. Students will receive PE, Arts, and Library/Media instruction each week. Based on enrollment, the school will be supported by a full-time counselor.
- Special Education: Currently, Buckman has one Learning Center and two SES classrooms. Sunnyside has three Learning Center classrooms. Hosford has two Learning Centers and one ISC classroom. With rightsizing, the Buckman SES classrooms will move with much of the Buckman student population to Sunnyside. Sunnyside will have a projected 3.5 Learning Center FTE and two SES classrooms. For the Sunnyside 6th-8th graders attending Hosford, Hosford will add a CB classroom to address neurodivergent Special Education needs. Hosford will have three Learning Center FTE, one ISC classroom, and one CB classroom.
- Student and Family Supports: Currently, both Sunnyside and Buckman offer before and after school programming. Our RESJ team is exploring an expansion of childcare capacity at Sunnyside. Currently, there is SUN programming at Buckman, but not at Sunnyside. Continued or expanded SUN programming will depend on County, PPS and City budget processes. Currently, there are no RESJ partners at Buckman or Sunnyside. RESJ partnerships continuing or expanding will be dependent on the PPS budget process. Currently, Buckman has a school-based mental health partnership with Morrison Child and Family Services. Student Services is reviewing partnership arrangements to support students transitioning to Sunnyside, as well as continuity of support for middle-grade students who may move from Sunnyside to Hosford.

SCHOOL BUILDING INFORMATION

Facility Indicator	Classroom Capacity	Special Education: Dedicated spaces & accessibility	Cafeteria / Nutrition Services	Gymnasium
Readiness	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes

TRANSPORTATION

Transportation	2027-2028
Students living within walkable zone – Elementary (1 mile), Middle (1.5 miles)	64.8%
Eligible bus riders	70
Estimated number of routes (not including special ed routes)	3
Hazard transportation routes (included in total routes above)	2

REINVESTMENTS FOR RECEIVING SCHOOLS

Schools that receive additional students through consolidation will be allocated a proportion of the total programmatic savings that result from Rightsizing actions. This allocation will be distributed as discretionary FTE that can be used for instructional coaching, academic intervention, school climate support, social work, or duty support. School principals, with consultation from their school communities and approval from their Senior Directors of Instructional Leadership, will determine how to use these additional investments.

School transition supports: Teams from Central Office have developed a framework for implementing Rightsizing. This includes a menu of transition supports for all impacted school communities. This work is informed by lessons learned by districts across the country that have had successful school consolidations. The implementation framework includes guidance on merging academic programs and school-based teams, (such as Instructional Leadership, Climate, PTAs and others) tools, resources, and timelines. The framework includes timelines for merging school communities and onboarding staff, families and students to their new campuses. It also includes staffing timelines and plans for packing and moving furniture and instructional resources. This comprehensive framework will be shared with the community in December. If the Board of Education votes to proceed with Rightsizing for fall 2027, Central Office teams will begin working with school communities in January to implement transition supports appropriate to each community.